



May
23

1934

Partners in crime

US outlaws Bonnie Parker and Clyde Champion Barrow were ambushed, shot, and killed by police officers in Louisiana, USA. Their crime spree of murder and robbery had finally caught up with them after two years on the run.

Born this day

1848 Otto Lilienthal, German aviator. He was known as the “Flying Man”, and his multiple successful flights were covered in newspapers published at the time.

1908 Hélène Boucher, French pilot. She set impressive world records for flight altitudes and speeds.



1618

Lucky escape

Angered by their Catholic king's decision to stop the building of a Protestant church, a mob in Bohemia, in present-day Czech Republic, threw the king's representatives out of the windows of Prague Castle.

Luckily, the men survived.

Astronomer's island

Danish astronomer Tycho Brahe was gifted Hven Island by King Frederick II, where he set up the Uraniborg Observatory. While working there, Brahe made important discoveries, such as the exact length of a year.

1576



Also on this day

1915 During World War I, Italy declared war on Austria-Hungary and sided with the Allies.

1962 US surgeon Ronald Malt reattached a young boy's severed arm – it was the first time this type of operation had been successful.

2015 Ireland became the first country to legalize same-sex marriage as a result of a public vote.